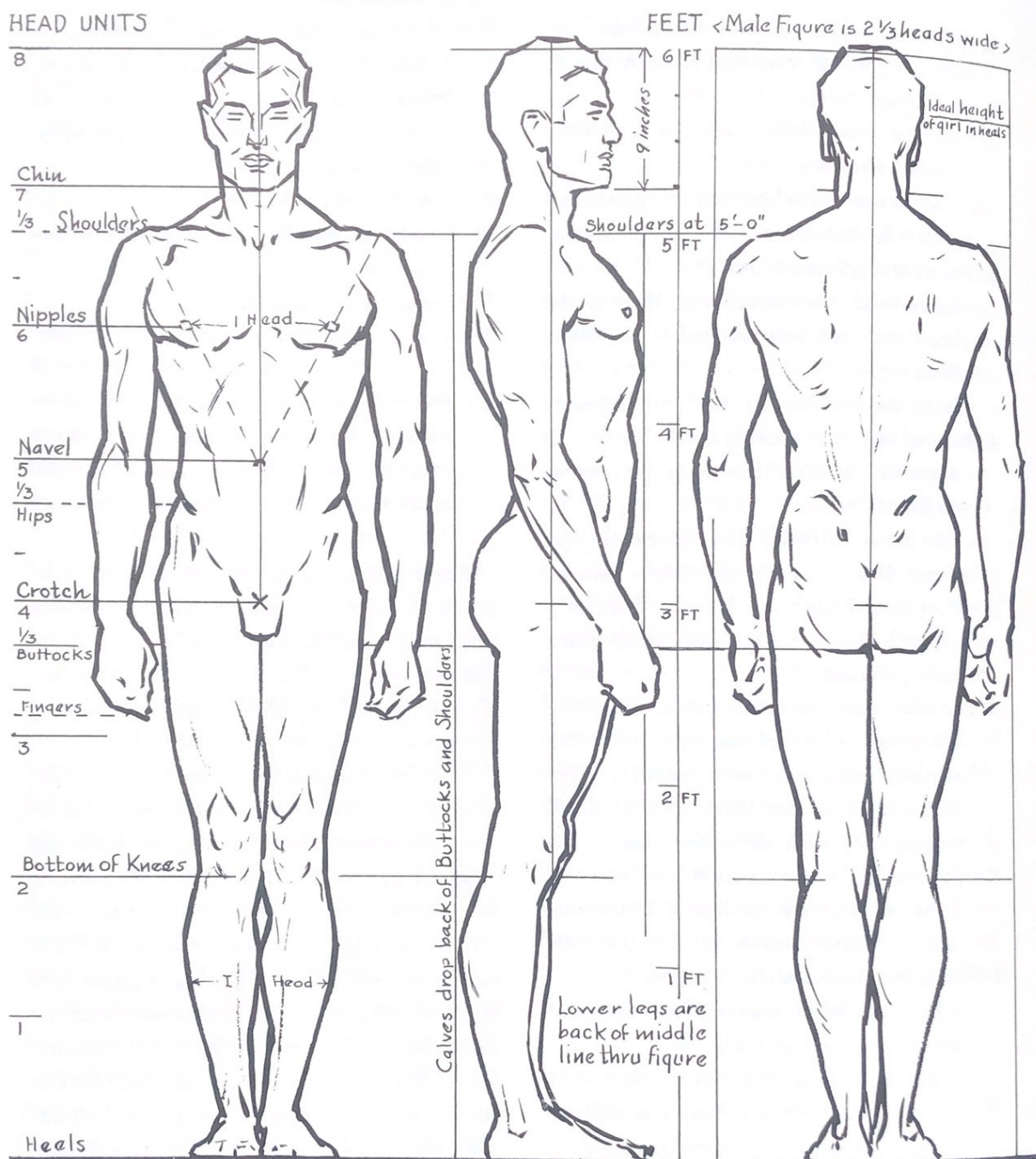


IDEAL PROPORTION, MALE



Take any desired height, or place points for top of head and heels. Divide into eighths. Two and one third of these units will be the relative width for the male figure. It is not necessary at this stage to attempt to render the anatomy correctly. But fix in your mind the divisions.

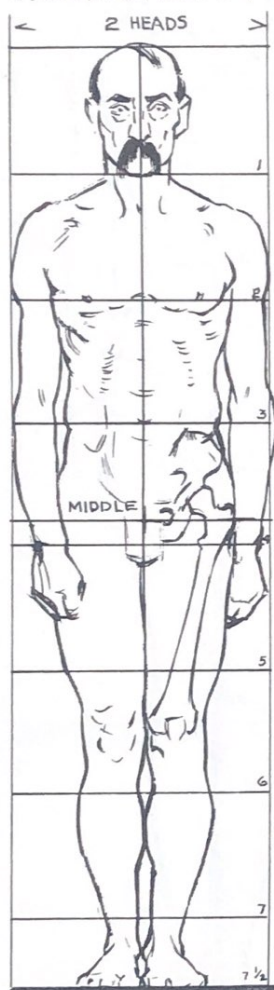
Draw the figure in the three positions: front, side, and back. Note the comparative widths at shoulders, hips, and calves. Note that the space

between nipples is one head unit. The waist is a little wider than one head unit. The wrist drops just below the crotch. The elbows are about on a line with the navel. The knees are just above the lower quarter of the figure. The shoulders are one-sixth of the way down. The proportions are also given in feet so that you may accurately relate your figure to furniture and interiors.

VARIOUS STANDARDS OF PROPORTION

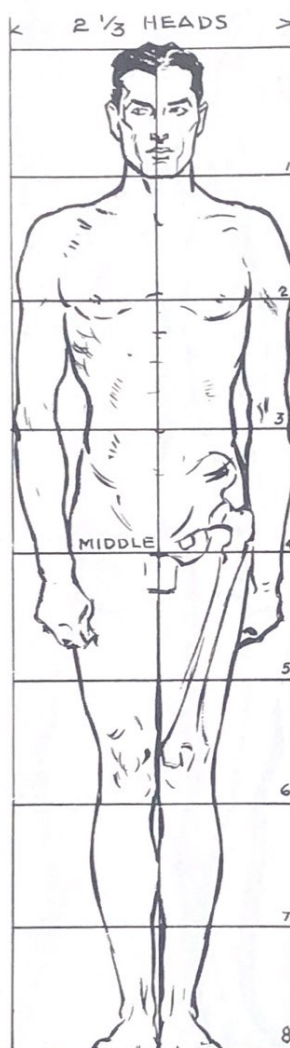
NORMAL, $7\frac{1}{2}$ HDS

THE ACADEMIC
PROPORTIONS
USED IN MOST SCHOOLS.
(RATHER DUMPY)



IDEALISTIC, 8 HDS

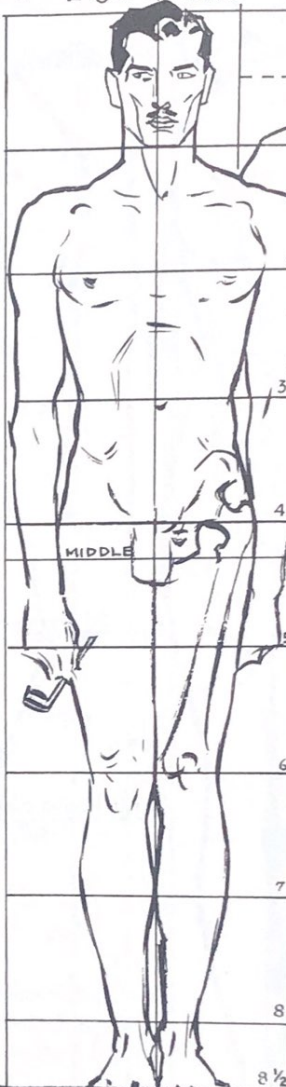
MOST ARTISTS ACCEPT
8 HEADS AS NORMAL



FASHION, $8\frac{1}{2}$ HDS

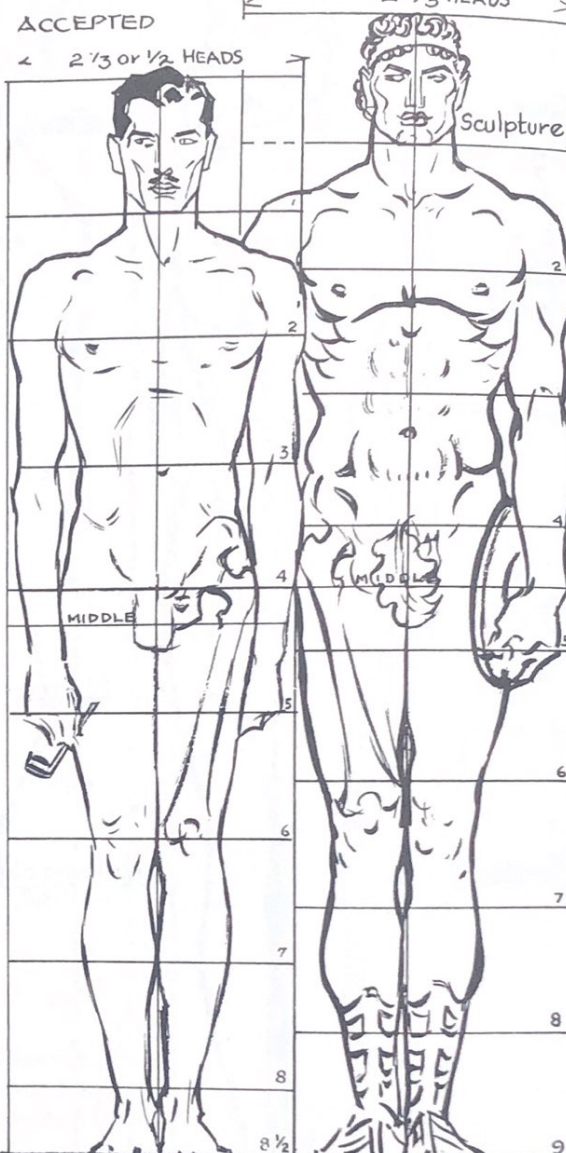
ACCEPTED

2 1/3 or 1/2 HEADS



HEROIC, 9 HDS

2 2/3 HEADS

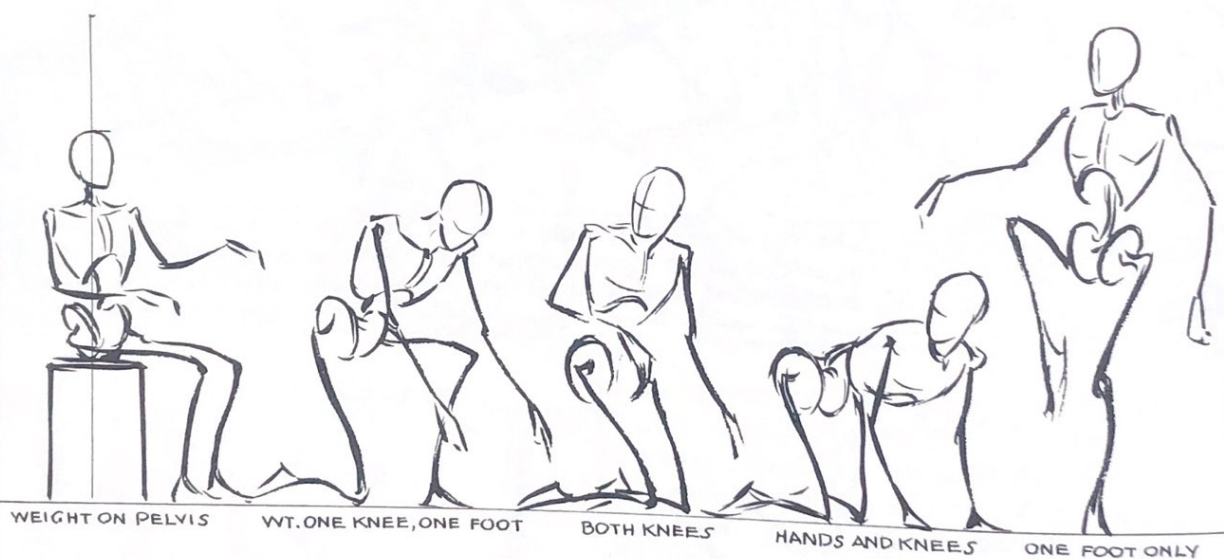
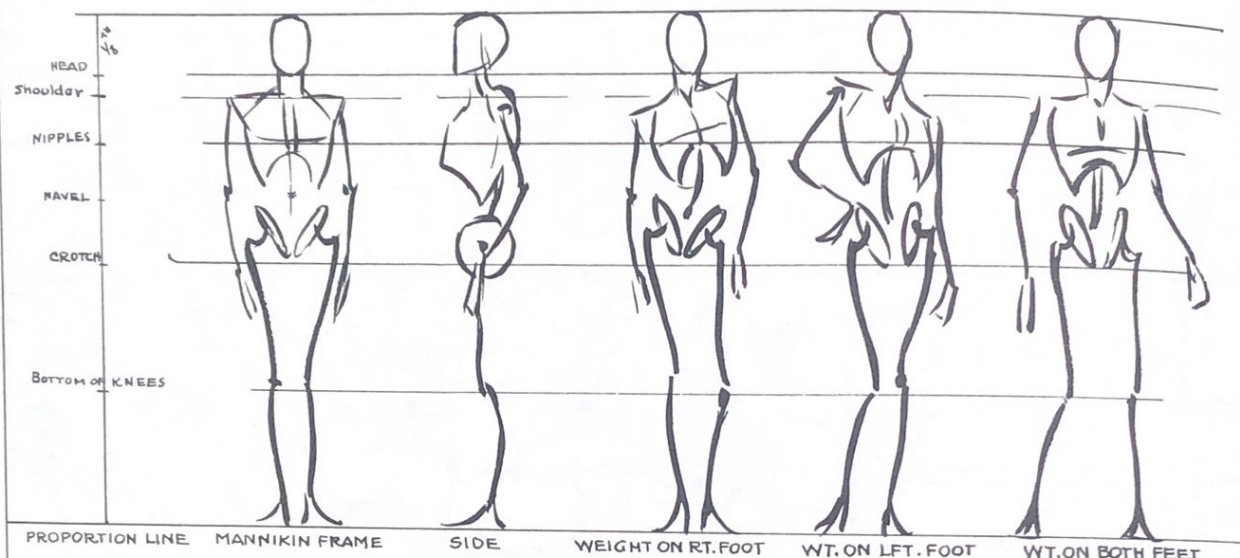


You can see at a glance why the actual or normal proportions are not very satisfactory. All academic drawings based on normal proportions have this dumpy, old-fashioned look. Most fashion artists stretch the figure even beyond eight heads, and in allegorical or heroic figures the "superhuman" type — nine heads — may be used effectively. Note at what point, or head

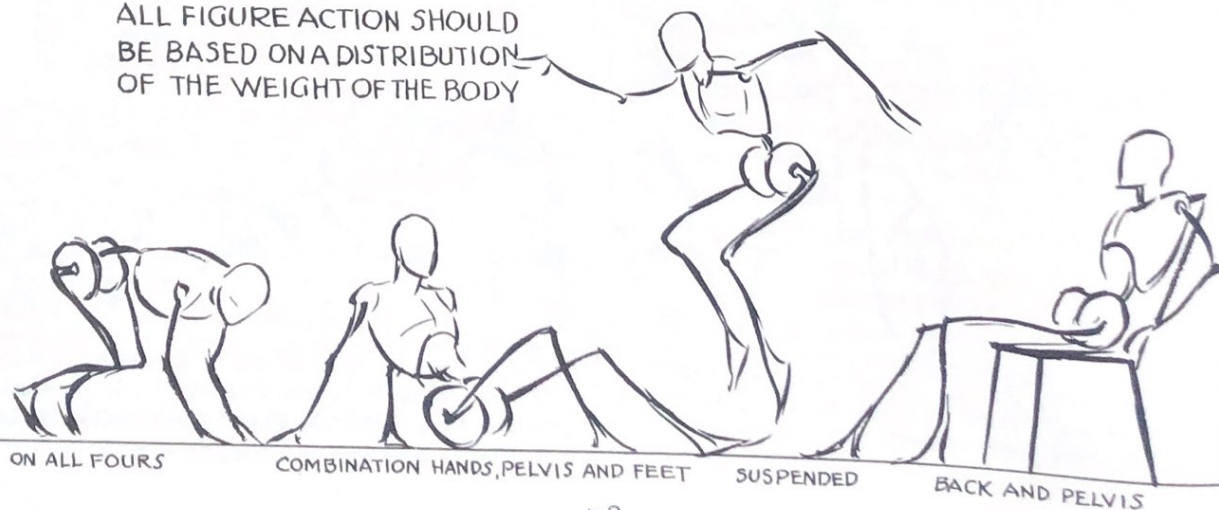
unit, the middle of the figure falls in each. It would be well to draw the side and back in these various proportions, using the previous page for a general guide but changing the proportion. You can control the appearance of height or shortness in any figure by the relative size of the head you use.

WE BEGIN TO DRAW: FIRST THE MANNIKIN FRAME

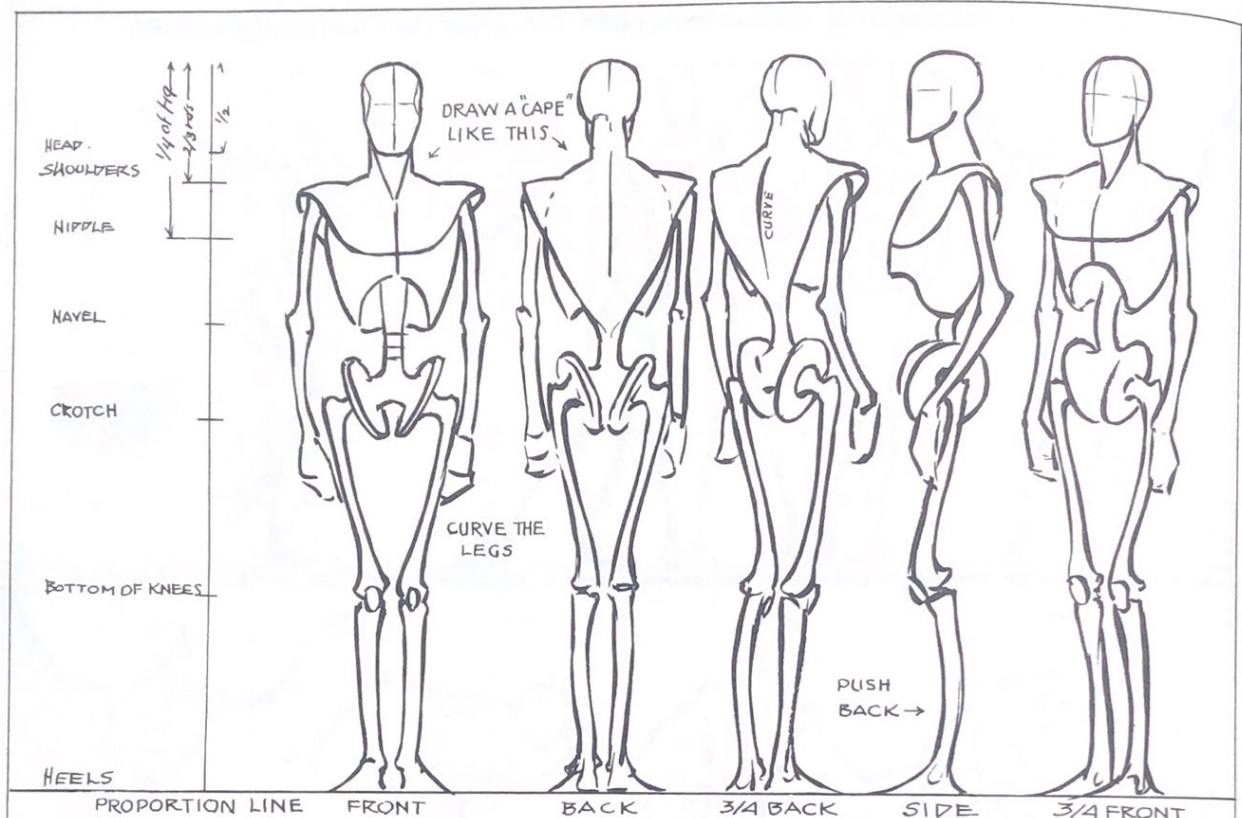
THE FIRST PROBLEM: HOW SHALL THE WEIGHT BE CARRIED?



ALL FIGURE ACTION SHOULD BE BASED ON A DISTRIBUTION OF THE WEIGHT OF THE BODY



DETAILS OF THE MANNIKIN FRAME

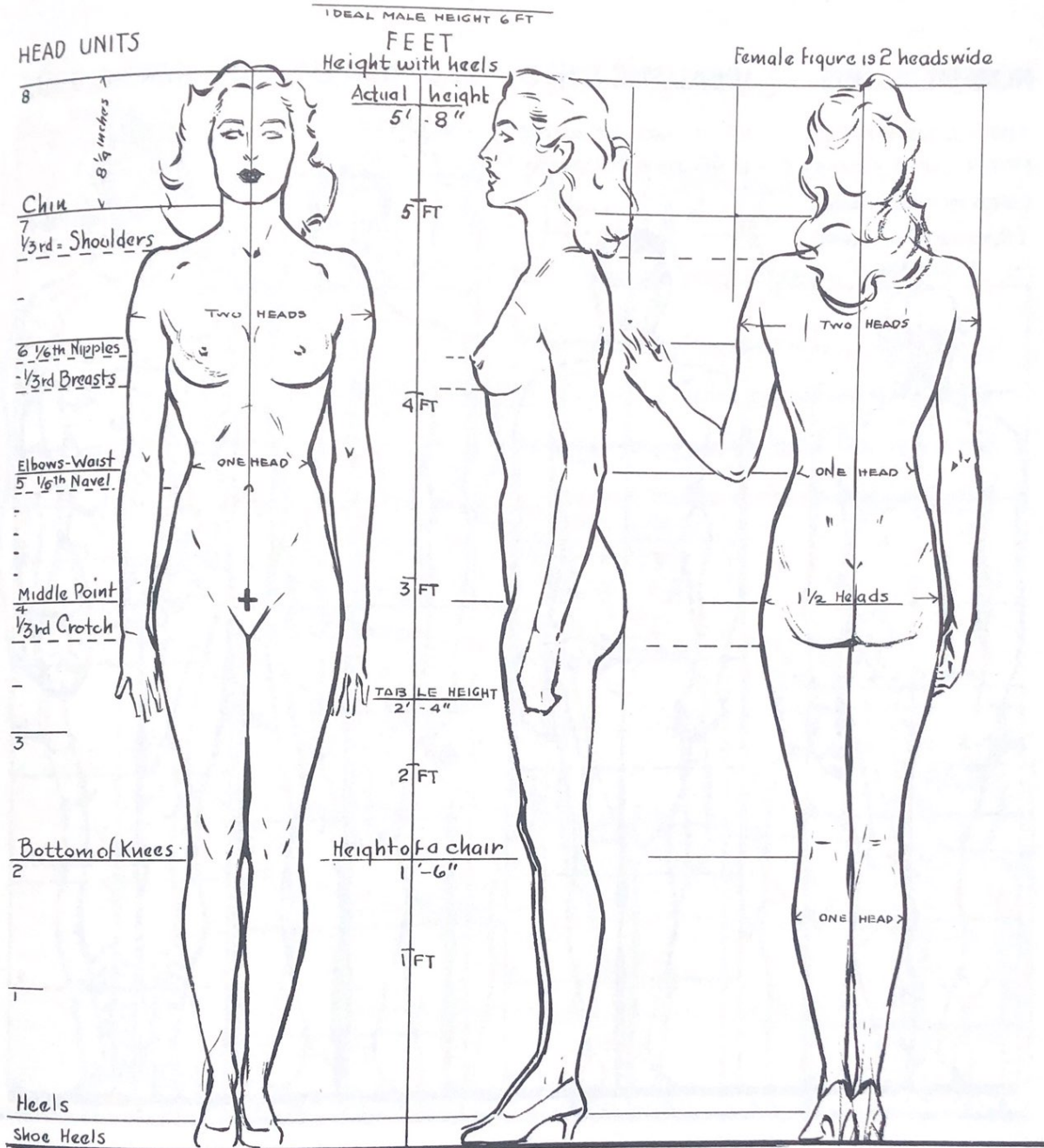


ALL THE TIME YOU SPEND ON THIS FELLOW PAYS BIG DIVIDENDS. LEARN ALL ABOUT HIM.



THIS IS A SIMPLIFIED VERSION OF THE ACTUAL FRAME - ALL YOU NEED FOR A START

IDEAL PROPORTION, FEMALE



The female figure is relatively narrower—two heads at the widest point. The nipples are slightly lower than in the male. The waistline measures one head unit across. In front the thighs are slightly wider than the armpits, narrower in back. It is optional whether or not you draw the legs even a little longer from the knees down. Wrists are even with crotch. Five feet eight inches (in heels) is considered an ideal height

for a girl. Actually, of course, the average girl has shorter legs and somewhat heavier thighs. Note carefully that the female navel is below the waistline; the male, above or even with it. The nipples and navel are one head apart, but both are dropped below the head divisions. The elbow is above the navel. It is important that you learn the variations between the male and female figure.

QUICK SET-UP OF PROPORTIONS

